

THE SEO DELIVERABLES CHECKLIST

What should actually land in your inbox once the work is underway — and how to spot filler before it costs you another month.

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You're paying every month, the invoices keep clearing, and you genuinely couldn't say what you got for it. That's not paranoia — SEO is one of the few things people buy where the work is invisible and the results lag by months. This checklist is for the **received** side of the relationship: what should actually show up, and how to tell a real deliverable from something that just fills the obligation to send it.

What Should Show Up Each Month

- ☐ **Technical change log** — specific pages and issues, in plain English
Not just a tool export. Names what was fixed and why it mattered.
- ☐ **Content produced** — what published, and why that topic was chosen
Titles and links you can actually open, tied to real searches your customers make.
- ☐ **Performance summary** — tied to a business outcome, not just vanity metrics
Sessions, leads, or calls — with honesty about what didn't move yet.
- ☐ **Next-month plan** — what's coming and why it's the priority
You should never have to ask "so what's actually happening next?"

Real Deliverable vs. Filler Deliverable

Category	Real	Filler
Technical	"Fixed meta titles and broken internal links on these 12 product pages."	A site-health score that went up, with no mention of what changed.
Content	Two guides targeting real searches — with the actual links.	"2 blog posts written" — no titles, no links, no reason.
Performance	Organic sessions rose; 3 form fills vs. 1 last month; branded flat, expected.	A wall of charts, disconnected from any business outcome.

The pattern: real deliverables are **specific** (they name things), **narrated** (a person explains them), and **honest** (they admit what didn't move). Charts and tool exports aren't the enemy — charts *instead of* a narrative are the problem.

Red Flags In What You're Receiving

- ✗ Reports that are just rank-tracking screenshots, with no narrative attached
- ✗ Generic monthly emails that could apply to literally any client
- ✗ No visibility into what's actually being worked on right now
- ✗ Deliverables that arrive late, inconsistently, or not at all some months
- ✗ Every month looks suspiciously identical, regardless of what actually happened

One caveat: format legitimately varies by engagement. A one-time audit produces a different kind of output than an ongoing retainer — this checklist is about substance, not a single template everyone must match.

Want the full breakdown — or a second opinion on what you're currently getting?

Read the full guide at richnashawaty.com/blog/seo-deliverables-checklist.html · Compare proposals side by side at richnashawaty.com/seo-pricing-comparison-worksheet.html · Get an independent audit at richnashawaty.com/local-seo-audit.html